

Geeky Alternatives

Using the same mainstream services as our non-geeky brethren is sacrilege. Here are some alternatives which will give you an edge and even make you look cool while you're at it

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Mainstream: Speedtest by Ookla (speedtest.net)

Geekier Alternative: OpenSpeedTest hosted by BSNL (<http://speedtest.bsnl.co.in/>)

Because: Come on, it's from BSNL and it doesn't suck. What more do you want? Apart from the patriotism swag, OpenSpeedTest like the name implies, is completely open source. It does nothing except what it is advertised to do, that is measure your internet speed and it feels much more snappy and responsive than Speedtest with a spartan but clean UI. It's also more accurate in finding your nearest servers and the results don't fluctuate as much as Speedtest over several tests, thereby giving you a more precise idea of what speeds you are exactly getting. Also, it doesn't sell your information like IP address to other people and did we mention that there's absolutely no ads?

Mainstream: Adblock for uh... adblocking

Geekier Alternative: Ublock Origin

Because: You either die a hero or live long enough to become the villain. Adblock started the revolution against the tyranny of ads long ago. But now, it's allowing companies to bribe it into whitelisting their ads? Unacceptable, old friend. It also sucks relatively more resources and its filters aren't updated that regularly either. Ublock Origin, while not exactly the new kid on the block, is still the

king of the hill. It's UI feels a little clunky at times but it's not terrible and its ad blocking is the best par none right now. Unless you want to spend some time learning how to make a *Pi Hole*. Now that's some quality ad blocking.

Mainstream: Google for googling search engines.

Geekier Alternative: Duck Duck Go (<https://duckduckgo.com/>)

Because: Everyone is sort of resigned to the fact that Google is privy to all your information. The Sun rises in the east, Half Life 3 is



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